

FILM DOSSIER: SILVER SURFER

Phase 2 · Film #9 (Saga Film #17) · PHASE 2 FINALE

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE.  Waiting on the showrunner's Mephisto pick (see Section 2).

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	17 of 29 (Phase 2, Film #9)
Phase	Phase 2 (finale)
Real title	<i>SILVER SURFER</i>
Decoy / codename title	" <i>BEACH DAY</i> "
Release date	Friday, November 6, 2015
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Guillermo del Toro
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 172 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + cosmic tragedy / apocalyptic epic

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	The Silver Surfer: Doug Jones (performance) with Laurence Fishburne (voice), the only real actors to have played Norrin Radd. The franchise is the Surfer's.

Character	Actor	Age at release
Norrin Radd / The Silver Surfer	Doug Jones (<i>on-set performance and full-body practical chrome makeup</i>) / Laurence Fishburne (voice)	55 / 54
Galactus	Ralph Ineson (<i>on-set performance and practical giant-scale sets</i>)	45
Shalla-Bal	Julia Garner	21
Alicia Masters	Kerry Washington	38
Uatu the Watcher	Jeffrey Wright	49
Reed Richards / Sue Storm / Johnny Storm / Ben Grimm	Pedro Pascal / Vanessa Kirby / Joseph Quinn / Ebon Moss-Bachrach	40 / 27 / 22 / 38
Adam Warlock (<i>post-credit</i>)	Will Poulter	22
Thanos	Josh Brolin	47
Death	Aubrey Plaza	31
Mephisto (<i>post-credit</i>)	 Showrunner's pick: Ciarán Hinds (62) · Peter Fonda (75)	–
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a man on a rooftop who shouts "Surf's up!"</i>)	Stan Lee	92

Mephisto note: Peter Fonda (as Mephistopheles, 2007) and Ciarán Hinds (as Roarke, 2011) have both played Marvel's Mephisto. Hinds is recommended because his version is the closer match to 616's Mephisto.

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	"The Galactus Trilogy", <i>Fantastic Four</i> #48–50 (1966), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby: the Watcher tries to hide Earth, the Silver Surfer arrives, Galactus comes to devour Earth, Alicia Masters reaches the Surfer's heart, the Human Torch gets the Ultimate Nullifier, and Galactus exiles the Surfer to Earth. <i>Silver Surfer</i> #1 (1968), Stan Lee & John Buscema: Norrin Radd's origin on Zenn-La, his love Shalla-Bal, and the bargain that saves his world.
Supporting comics	<i>The Thanos Quest</i> #2 (1990, Starlin & Lim): Thanos completes the Gauntlet, and Death rejects him because he's now more powerful than she is · <i>Silver Surfer</i> #3 (1968, Mephisto) · <i>Warlock</i> #15 (1977) and <i>Marvel Two-in-One Annual</i> #2 (1977): Adam Warlock's soul is taken into the Soul Gem · <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> #1 (1991): Mephisto at Thanos's side
Nerf check	✅ Galactus can't be beaten by force. The FF can't touch him . He leaves only because of the Ultimate Nullifier , the one weapon he fears, and the Surfer's betrayal. The Surfer's Power Cosmic makes him a match for all four of the FF together .

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	97%. The Galactus Trilogy and <i>Silver Surfer</i> #1 are adapted almost exactly, with <i>The Thanos Quest</i> #2's ending as the post-credit scene.

Straight from the page:

- Uatu the **Watcher** breaks his **oath** to try to **hide Earth** from Galactus's herald, using a false fire in the sky (*FF* #48).
- **The Silver Surfer** finds Earth anyway and **summons Galactus** (#48).
- **Galactus**, the Devourer of Worlds, builds his **world-eating machine** on top of the Baxter Building (#49).
- The Surfer, wounded, falls through the skylight of the blind sculptor **Alicia Masters**. She's **the first person who has ever shown him compassion**, and he **rediscovers his humanity** (#48–49).
- **The Surfer turns on Galactus** (#49–50).
- Uatu sends the **Human Torch** across the universe to Galactus's ship to get **the Ultimate Nullifier** (#49–50).
- **Reed threatens Galactus with the Nullifier**. Galactus leaves Earth and **punishes the Surfer with a barrier that traps him on Earth forever** (#50).
- **Norrin Radd** of **Zenn-La** offered himself to Galactus as a herald **to save his world**, and left **Shalla-Bal** behind (*SS* #1).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

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| The Surfer's origin (1968) is told **inside** the Galactus Trilogy (1966) as flashbacks | It makes this **the Surfer's own film** |

| The Thanos Quest's ending is the post-credit scene | It closes Phase 2 and sets up the Infinity Gauntlet |
 | Warlock's soul is taken by Thanos, not by his past self (1977) | MCU continuity. The result is the same: **his soul is inside the Soul Gem**, as on 616 before *The Infinity Gauntlet*. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
The Silver Surfer	The Power Cosmic: energy blasts at planet-scale, faster-than-light travel on his board, matter manipulation, near-invulnerability , survives in space, cosmic awareness (<i>FF</i> #48, <i>SS</i> #1)	Takes on all four of the FF at once and wins; FTL flight in flashbacks; turns a nuclear missile into flowers	His full cosmic-scale feats (later films, as the threats grow)	 100%
Galactus	The Power Cosmic at its limit: he eats planets, reshapes matter at will, and gives and takes the Power Cosmic ; effectively a force of nature (<i>FF</i> #48–50)	His world-eating machine; he ignores the FF's attacks completely ; he puts a barrier around a whole planet	—	 100%
The Ultimate Nullifier	Can erase anything , including Galactus	Its threat alone ends the battle	—	 100%
The Fantastic Four	As in <i>Fantastic Four</i>	Fighting the Surfer; Johnny's trip into Galactus's ship	—	 100%
Uatu	Cosmic power; the vow never to interfere	Breaks his vow	—	 100%
Thanos (with six Gems)	Omnipotence	The post-credit scene	Everything (Phase 3)	 100%
Mephisto	A lord of a hell-dimension ; master manipulator; enormous mystic power	The post-credit scene	Everything (Phase 3)	 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	A cosmic herald leads a planet-eating god to Earth, the way he has led him to a thousand other worlds. A blind woman's kindness reminds him what it was like to be a man, and he betrays his master to save a world that isn't his.
Theme	Sacrifice. Norrin gave up his world, his love and his soul to save Zenn-La. On Earth he learns there's still something he can give up.
Villain / antagonist	Galactus (a force of nature, not evil); Thanos (post-credit)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE HERALD

- **Zenn-La, long ago.** Norrin Radd, a scientist who longs for the stars, watches **Galactus** arrive to devour his peaceful world. Norrin offers himself **as herald** in exchange for Zenn-La's survival. Galactus accepts, and Norrin is covered in silver and cut off from his heart. **Shalla-Bal** is left behind (flashback).
- **Monday, August 10, 2015.** On the Moon, **Uatu the Watcher breaks his oath** and hides Earth behind a false fire in the sky.
- **The Silver Surfer** finds Earth anyway, and **calls his master.**

ACT TWO: THE DEVOURER

- **Galactus** arrives over New York and starts building his machine on top of **the Baxter Building.**
- **The Fantastic Four** attack, and **it's like fighting weather.**
- The Surfer fights the FF and wins. He's **hurt**, falls, and crashes through the skylight of **Alicia Masters.**
- Alicia, who is blind, can't see what he is. She sees who he is, and she talks to him about beauty, about life, and about being human.
- **For the first time in centuries, Norrin Radd feels something.**

ACT THREE: THE ULTIMATE NULLIFIER

- The Surfer **turns on Galactus.** The Power Cosmic against the Power Cosmic, over Manhattan.
 - **Uatu** sends **Johnny Storm** across the universe to Galactus's worldship to get the one weapon Galactus fears: **the Ultimate Nullifier.**
 - **Reed** stands on the Baxter Building roof holding the Nullifier. **Galactus backs down.**
 - Galactus leaves, and **punishes his herald:** *"You have chosen this world. Then you shall never leave it."* He puts **an invisible barrier** around Earth.
 - The last scene is **the Surfer, alone**, flying at the barrier over and over, then turning his face toward the stars he'll never reach again. On a rooftop below, Alicia waits.
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Zenn-La, centuries ago (flashbacks) · Monday, August 10, 2015 → Saturday, October 17, 2015 . The post-credit scene is undated (deep space).
Where it's set	Zenn-La · the Moon (the Blue Area) · the Baxter Building, NYC · Galactus's worldship, Taa II · the Soul World (post-credit) (filmed on location in New York, with enormous practical sets for the worldship)
Relative to other films	Three months after <i>Yellowjacket</i> . The Avengers are fighting Galactus's side effects: earthquakes and tidal waves, shown in a montage.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Galactus**, the **Power Cosmic**, **Zenn-La**, **Shalla-Bal**, the **Ultimate Nullifier**.
- **The Surfer trapped on Earth**, the cosmos's most powerful exile.
- **Alicia and the Surfer**, and **Ben's** heartbreak.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The Surfer on Earth	The barrier	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> (on 616, the Surfer is the first to warn Earth)
The Watcher breaks his oath	Uatu interferes	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i>
Mephisto	The post-credit scene	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i>
Warlock in the Soul Gem	The post-credit scene	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> (on 616, Warlock escapes the Soul Gem to lead the heroes)

Setting up the Big Bad: THE GAUNTLET IS COMPLETE

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Gems #5 and #6	The post-credit scene	Thanos has all six.
Death rejects him	The post-credit scene	On 616, Death won't speak to Thanos because he's now her superior (<i>The Thanos Quest</i> #2)
Mephisto	The post-credit scene	He'll whisper to Thanos all through Phase 3

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✅ "ZENN-LA." Very far away, on a peaceful green world, Shalla-Bal stands on a hill looking at the stars. " <i>Norrin. Where are you?</i> "
Post-credit scene	✅ "THE INFINITY GAUNTLET." A salt flat on a distant world. The Runner, the fastest of the Elders, lies still in the dust, run down at last. Thanos lifts the fifth Gem from his hand. SMASH CUT: Deep space. Adam Warlock floats in a blazing column of light. Thanos faces him, gauntlet raised. THANOS: "<i>I told you, Warlock. In time.</i>" The Soul Gem tears free of Warlock's forehead, and Warlock's soul is pulled in after it, screaming. His body turns to dust. CUT TO: Thanos's throne. The Infinity Gauntlet holds all six Gems (Soul, Mind, Power, Space, Time and Reality) in green, blue, red, purple, orange and yellow. He turns to Death, triumphant: "<i>Everything I have, I have done for you. Speak to me.</i>" Death looks at him. And turns away. She's afraid of him now. Thanos stands alone. Out of the shadows behind the throne, a figure in red steps forward with a silky voice: MEPHISTO. MEPHISTO: "<i>She fears you now, Titan. You've become too great for her. But I know a way to win her heart...</i>" Thanos doesn't turn around. He looks at the Gauntlet. CUT TO BLACK. TITLE CARD: "THE INFINITY GAUNTLET"
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " POSTCARD. " Post-credit: " GLOVE BOX. "

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline · ☒ FF cast · 
Mephisto casting pick